



**Explanatory Note to ED Decision 2026/006/R,
ED Decision 2026/007/R and ED Decision 2026/008/R**
issued in accordance with Article 4(2) of MB Decision No 01-2022

Update of the flight simulation training device requirements

RMT.0196 – Subtask 2

WHAT THESE DECISIONS ARE ABOUT

This document contains information regarding the following Decisions:

- ED Decision amending the acceptable means of compliance (AMC) and guidance material (GM) to Regulation (EU) No 1178/2011;
- ED Decision amending the AMC and GM to Regulation (EU) No 965/2012; and
- ED Decision issuing CS-FSTD Issue 1.

In relation to Regulation (EU) No 1178/2011, EASA issues amendments to the AMC and GM to support the implementation of Regulation (EU) 2026/781 in the context of the qualification of flight simulation training devices (FSTDs) with FSTD capability signature (FCS) and the use of FSTDs with FCS or assigned FCS in task-to-tool methodology for aeroplane and helicopter type rating training.

In relation to Regulation (EU) No 965/2012, EASA issues amendments to the AMC and GM to support the implementation of Regulation (EU) 2026/781 in the context of the use of FSTDs with FCS or assigned FCS in operator recurrent training.

In relation to CS-FSTD Issue 1, EASA issues new certification specifications for the qualification of aeroplane and helicopter FSTDs, based on the FSTD capabilities and fidelity levels specified in the FCS.

The amendments to the AMC and GM and the issuance of CS-FSTD Issue 1 are intended to enhance flexibility in the qualification and use of FSTDs in type rating training and in operator recurrent training. All mentioned Decisions will apply on the same date when Regulation (EU) 2026/781 will apply. EASA will initiate an implementation support task — IST.0007 'Support the implementation of the FSTD capability signature (FCS) framework' to support stakeholders in the implementation of the updated FSTD framework.

REGULATION(S) INTENDED TO BE AMENDED:

Not applicable.

ED DECISIONS TO BE AMENDED AFTER THE ADOPTION OF THE REGULATION:

- [ED Decision 2011/016/R - AMC & GM to Regulation \(EU\) No 1178/2011 | EASA \(europa.eu\)](#)
- [ED Decision 2012/006/R - AMC & GM to Part-ARA | EASA \(europa.eu\)](#)
- [ED Decision 2018/009/R - AMC/GM to Annex VIII \(Part-DTO\) to Regulation \(EU\) No 1178/2011 & update of the related AMC/GM to Annex I \(Part-FCL\) & to Annex VI \(Part-ARA\) to Regulation \(EU\) No 1178/2011 | EASA](#)
- [ED Decision 2012/007/R - AMC & GM to Part-ORA | EASA \(europa.eu\)](#)
- [ED Decision 2014/017/R - AMC & GM Part-ORO - Issue 2 | EASA \(europa.eu\)](#)

ED DECISION TO BE ISSUED AFTER THE ADOPTION OF THE REGULATION:

ED Decision on CS-FSTD, Issue 1

AFFECTED STAKEHOLDERS

AOC holders (CAT), approved training organisations (ATOs), declared training organisations (DTOs), FSTD operators and manufacturers, original equipment manufacturers, pilots, instructors, flight examiners, competent authorities

WORKING METHODS

Development	Impact assessment(s)	Consultation
By EASA with external support	Detailed	NPA 2020-15 – Public; NPA 2024-101 – Focused consultation; NPA 2024-102 – Focused consultation; NPA 2024-108 – Focused consultation

RELATED DOCUMENTS/INFORMATION

[ToR RMT.0196 'Update of flight simulation training devices requirements'](#); [NPA 2020-15 'Update of the flight simulation training device requirements'](#); [NPA 2024-101](#); [NPA 2024-102](#); [NPA 2024-108](#); [Opinion No 01/2025](#).

PLANNING MILESTONES: Refer to the latest edition of EPAS *Volume II*.



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1. About these Decisions

The European Union Aviation Safety Agency (EASA) developed three Executive Director Decisions (EDDs) as follows:

- EDD amending the AMC and GM to Regulation (EU) No 1178/2011¹ (the Aircrew Regulation) and its Annex I (Part-FCL), Annex VI (Part-ARA) and Annex VII (Part-ORA);
- EDD amending the AMC and GM to Subpart FC of Annex III (Part-ORO) to Regulation (EU) No 965/2012² (the Air OPS Regulation); and
- EDD issuing the new CS-FSTD Issue 1.

The three EDDs are part of the deliverables of rulemaking task (RMT) 'RMT.0196 – Update of the flight simulation training device requirements', and were developed by EASA based on the input of the Rulemaking Group for RMT.0196.

EASA developed this regulatory material in line with Regulation (EU) 2018/1139³ (the Basic Regulation) and the Rulemaking Procedure⁴, as well as in accordance with the objectives and working methods described in the Terms of Reference (ToR) for this RMT⁵.

The draft regulatory material was consulted in accordance with the ToR for this RMT with the affected stakeholders through the following consultations:

- NPA 2020-15 'Update of the flight simulation training device requirements' (public consultation);
- NPA 2024-101 with regulatory amendments and supporting AMC and GM to Part-FCL and Part-ORA, Subpart ATO of the Aircrew Regulation and to Part-ORO, Subpart FC of the Air OPS Regulation, and workshop on 17–19 June 2024 (focused consultation);
- NPA 2024-102 on a draft new CS-FSTD Issue 1, and workshop on 18–19 September 2024 (focused consultation);

¹ Commission Regulation (EU) No 1178/2011 of 3 November 2011 laying down technical requirements and administrative procedures related to civil aviation aircrew pursuant to Regulation (EC) No 216/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council (OJ L 311, 25.11.2011, p. 1, <http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg/2011/1178/oj>).

² Commission Regulation (EU) No 965/2012 of 5 October 2012 laying down technical requirements and administrative procedures related to air operations pursuant to Regulation (EC) No 216/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council (OJ L 296, 25.10.2012, p. 1, <http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg/2012/965/oj>).

³ Regulation (EU) 2018/1139 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 4 July 2018 on common rules in the field of civil aviation and establishing a European Union Aviation Safety Agency, and amending Regulations (EC) No 2111/2005, (EC) No 1008/2008, (EU) No 996/2010, (EU) No 376/2014 and Directives 2014/30/EU and 2014/53/EU of the European Parliament and of the Council, and repealing Regulations (EC) No 552/2004 and (EC) No 216/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council and Council Regulation (EEC) No 3922/91 (OJ L 212, 22.8.2018, p. 1, <http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg/2018/1139/oj>).

⁴ EASA is bound to follow a structured rulemaking process as required by Article 115(1) of Regulation (EU) 2018/1139. Such a process has been adopted by the EASA Management Board (MB) and is referred to as the 'Rulemaking Procedure'. See MB Decision No 01-2022 of 2 May 2022 on the procedure to be applied by EASA for the issuing of opinions, certification specifications and other detailed specifications, acceptable means of compliance and guidance material ('Rulemaking Procedure'), and repealing Management Board Decision No 18-2015 ([EASA MB Decision No 01-2022 on the Rulemaking Procedure, repealing MB Decision 18-2015 \(by written procedure\) | EASA \(europa.eu\)](#)).

⁵ ToR RMT.0196, 'Update of flight simulation training devices requirements', Issue 4 ([ToR RMT.0196 - Update of flight simulation training devices requirements | EASA](#)).

- NPA 2024-108 on the draft AMC and GM associated with the amendments to the Aircrew Regulation, Part-ARA, Subparts GEN and FSTD, and Part-ORA, Subpart FSTD, and workshop on 9–11 December 2024 (focused consultation).

EASA reviewed the comments received and duly considered them in the preparation of the regulatory material presented here.

EASA published Opinion No 01/2025 on 19 May 2025, proposing amendments to the Aircrew Regulation and the Air OPS Regulation, based on which the European Commission adopted Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2026/781 on 8 April 2026⁶, amending those Regulations.

⁶ Commission Implementing Regulation(EU) 2026/781 of 8 April 2026 amending Regulations (EU) No 1178/2011 and (EU) No 965/2012 as regards the requirements applicable to flight simulation training devices and the use of those devices for pilot training, testing and checking (OJ L, 2026/781, 10.4.2026, ELI: http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg_impl/2026/781/oj).



2. In summary — why and what

2.1. Why we need to act

Regulation (EU) 2026/781, amending the Aircrew Regulation and the Air OPS Regulation, introduced a new regulatory approach for the qualification of FSTDs, based on the FSTD features and fidelity levels specified in the FCS of an FSTD, and on the implementation of a task-to-tool methodology for aeroplane and helicopter type rating training and operator recurrent training.

Following the adoption of Regulation (EU) 2026/781, the current AMC and GM to the Aircrew and Air Operations Regulations need to be updated in order to establish the means of compliance and guidance in support of the new provisions. CS-FSTD issue 1 is issued to provide new technical specifications for FSTDs with FCS.

2.2. What we want to achieve — objectives

The overall objectives of the EASA system are defined in Article 1 of the Basic Regulation. The regulatory material presented here is expected to contribute to achieving these overall objectives by addressing the issues described in Section 2.1.

More specifically, with the regulatory material presented here, EASA intends to support the implementation of Regulation (EU) 2026/781 to better facilitate the identification of technical capabilities of FSTDs and enable a clear link between such capabilities and identified training needs. The detailed objectives of the new regulatory approach for the qualification of FSTDs are explained in Section 2.2 of EASA Opinion No 01/2025.

2.3. How we want to achieve it — overview of the amendments

An overview of the major amendments is presented below. In addition, detailed information with rationales for each amended AMC and GM is provided in Appendix 5 to this Explanatory Note.

2.3.1. AMC and GM to the Aircrew Regulation

AMC and GM to Part-FCL

Training matrices for type rating training

Regulation (EU) 2026/781 introduces the task-to-tool methodology and the FCS framework for type rating initial and renewal training (Appendix 9 to Annex I (Part-FCL) to the Aircrew Regulation). In order to apply this framework, training matrices for type rating training programmes for multi-pilot aeroplanes, for single-pilot high-performance complex aeroplanes and for helicopters are introduced at AMC level.

The training matrices are established as tables consisting of Appendix 9 training exercises in the rows and FSTD features in the columns. For each exercise, two FCSs are determined:

- T: Training; and
- TP: Training to proficiency.

In order to obtain training credit towards the minimum FSTD training time established in point (j) of AMC2 ORA.ATO.125 for aeroplanes and in points (c) and (d) of AMC2 FCL.725(a) for helicopters,



training tasks may be initiated using an FSTD whose FCS or assigned FCS is equal to or higher than the minimum FCS for T and should be completed using an FSTD whose FCS or assigned FCS is equal to or higher than the minimum FCS for TP.

The training matrices have been determined by analysing, for each training task, the minimum acceptable fidelity level for each FSTD feature, considering the identified training requirements stemming from type rating training courses and the technical requirements of CS-FSTD Issue 1.

The training matrices should not be used as stand-alone tools to determine the suitability of a training device for the training tasks but should rather be used in the training course design process described in AMC5 ORA.ATO.125.

AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart GEN

FSTD inspector qualification and training

The amendments to AMC2 ARA.GEN.200(a)(2) and the new GM4 ARA.GEN.200(a)(2) are aimed to clarify the qualification and training for the FSTD inspectors, to provide support to the competent authority in defining the training programme for the FSTD inspectors, and to enable standardisation of the qualification and training of FSTD inspectors across Member States.

AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD

Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD is replaced with a new version of AMC and GM (Issue 1, Amendment 15). The reasoning for the replacement is that the amendments to AMC and GM affect their sequence, changing their titles and numbering. Consequently, the presentation of the amendments within the existing text would render the text very difficult to follow. A correlation table between the AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD, Issue 1, Amendment 14 and the AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD, Issue 1, Amendment 15 is provided in Appendix 4 to this Explanatory Note.

In some cases, the amendments do not necessarily affect the content of existing AMC and GM (Issue 1, Amendment 14) but the content was revised to align the order of the AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD with the amendments adopted with Regulation (EU) 2026/781.

The major amendments introduced to the AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD are the following:

- revision of the arrangements for the composition of the FSTD evaluation team (AMC2 ARA.FSTD.100(a);(b);(c));
- redrafting of the FSTD evaluation report to accommodate the FCS framework, and introduction of a new classification of the items raised by the competent authority (AMC1 ARA.FSTD.100(d));
- amendment of the text in AMC1 ARA.FSTD.115 for an FSTD interim qualification with CS-FSTD Issue 1;
- deletion of several AMC and GM due to either being obsolete in the context of the FCS framework or due to the reorganisation of the whole Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD;
- introduction of the new AMC2 ARA.FSTD.130 to clarify the evaluation considerations for the competent authority concerning FSTD modifications.



AMC and GM to Part-ORA, Subpart ATO

Training organisations providing type rating training

Training organisations can apply the FCS framework for type rating training on a voluntary basis. Dedicated text in AMC1 ORA.ATO.125 clarifies the possibility for the training organisation to use a combination of legacy FSTDs, FSTDs with FCS, FSTDs with assigned FCS or a combination thereof. However, for training programmes designed using the task-to-tool methodology, only FSTDs with FCS or assigned FCS should be used.

The amendments in AMC2 ORA.ATO.125 also clarify the use of FSTDs with FCS or assigned FCS as regards their compatibility with the training footprint of operational suitability data (OSD). The amendments allow for the training organisations to deviate from the use of the training devices specified in the training footprint of OSD in the case of training programmes designed in accordance with AMC5 ORA.ATO.125. This arrangement enables the use of the most suitable FSTDs with FCS or assigned FCS. Similar arrangements are included in AMC3 ORA.ATO.125 for helicopters, with an addition that clarifies how to determine the minimum training time in the helicopter.

The amendments in AMC2 ORA.ATO.125 also bring about flexibility and alleviations for pilots to complete a minimum of 16 hours in a full flight simulator (FFS) during a multi-pilot aeroplane type rating training course. Training programmes designed by leveraging on the FCS framework may include less than 16 hours of training time spent in an FSTD whose FCS is equivalent to that of an FFS. This is possible through the proper use of instructional systems design (ISD) principles and a robust procedure for training course design, in accordance with AMC5 ORA.ATO.125 and GM2 ORA.ATO.125.

Arrangements for designing a type rating training programme using the task-to-tool methodology

The new AMC5 ORA.ATO.125 illustrates the steps to be followed by the training organisation when designing a type rating training programme using the task-to-tool methodology. The key principles are the following:

- the training course design should be based on ISD principles;
- every training task should be completed in an FSTD whose FCS or assigned FCS is equal to or higher than the corresponding TP level FCS in the applicable training matrix, and all the relevant elements of a training task should be covered in the training programme;
- the training devices used for the training course should have an FCS or an assigned FCS in the qualification certificate.

Instructional systems design principles for training course design

ISD principles are explained in GM2 ORA.ATO.125 to support the introduction of the task-to-tool training methodology. In this context, the choice of suitable training devices to be used in a training course depends on the training course design. The guidance material provides step-by-step information on the workflows composing the ADDIE model (Analyse, Design, Develop, Implement, Evaluate) and the elements that form an integral part of a training course designed following such principles.

ISD principles are deemed to be important also for other existing training courses, such as APS MCC and Area 100 KSA. In the future, such principles will also constitute the basis for the introduction of the competency-based training and assessment (CBTA) methodology for Part-FCL training courses.



AMC and GM to Part-ORA, Subpart FSTD

FSTD performance metrics

To demonstrate compliance with point ORA.FSTD.100(d), AMC1 ORA.FSTD.100(d) establishes a list of FSTD performance metrics which the organisations operating the FSTD should provide to the competent authorities. AMC1 ORA.FSTD.100(d) and GM1 ORA.FSTD.100(d) were completely revised following the comments on NPA 2024-108. AMC1 ORA.FSTD.100(d) clarifies the objectives and provides a set of metrics which the organisation should report. Nevertheless, the AMC provides flexibility for the organisations to develop additional metrics or additional information as necessary, tailored to the needs of the organisation. By defining a minimum set of metrics for measuring the FSTD performance and use, AMC1 ORA.FSTD.100(d) serves the needs for demonstrating compliance and facilitates standardisation of FSTD metrics across the organisations.

Maintaining the FSTD qualification

Several AMC to point ORA.FSTD.105, as amended by Regulation (EU) 2026/781, are introduced to provide means of compliance for maintaining FSTD qualification standards, conducting the functional pre-flight check, conducting the objective, functions and subjective tests of the FSTD in accordance with the Master Qualification Test Guide (MQTG) and maintaining the FSTD configuration control and management.

Management of FSTD modifications

Several new AMC and GM are introduced to support the implementation of point ORA.FSTD.110 concerning FSTD modifications. The new AMC1 ORA.FSTD.110(a) provides flexible arrangements for the relocation of an FSTD. The organisation operating the FSTD should develop a proportionate testing plan according to the device and the nature of the move.

The new AMC1 ORA.FSTD.110(b)(2) is introduced to provide details on the content of the procedure which the organisation operating the FSTD should follow if a major modification of the FSTD is performed without prior approval by the competent authority.

Amendments in AMC1 ORA.FSTD.110 are introduced to clarify how an FSTD with assigned FCS can be modified. First, the organisation operating the FSTD should assess the impact of the major modification on the compliance of the FSTD with respect to its qualification basis. Thereafter, the organisation may:

- perform such major modification without affecting the assigned FCS and the compliance of the FSTD with the qualification basis specified in Appendix IX to Annex VI (Part-ARA); or
- decide to apply for an FCS by using the qualification basis applicable at the time of the modification (e.g. CS-FSTD Issue 1).

Equipment specification list (ESL)

Several new AMC are introduced to provide general arrangements for the ESL, the template of the ESL and instructions on how to complete the ESL. The key points are the following:

- each FSTD certificate should be accompanied by the ESL, including legacy FSTDs, except BITD;
- the ESL is the main document which specifies the complete configuration of the FSTD, the equipment, specifications and capabilities;



- the ESL, together with the FSTD qualification certificate, establishes the suitability of the device to support a training programme;
- the FSTD users should use the ESL as a main tool to determine the overall adequacy of the FSTD for training, testing and checking;
- the organisation operating the FSTD should verify and validate each entry (equipment, specifications, capabilities) in the ESL;
- the organisation operating the FSTD should update the ESL to accurately represent the installed equipment, specifications and capabilities at all times;
- the ESL should be subject to management of modifications in accordance with point ORA.FSTD.110;
- the ESL may indicate limitations of the FSTD related to the relevant feature.

The dedicated AMC2 ORA.FSTD.120 outlines the ESL template. The design of the template is on purpose kept with blank boxes in order to allow that accommodation of the information for any FSTD (legacy FSTD, FSTD with assigned FCS or FSTD with FCS). The template is organised by FSTD features as this enables easy visualisation of the equipment, specifications and capabilities which support that FSTD feature. In the case of legacy FSTDs, the FCS of the FSTD will not be specified. However, the installed equipment, specifications and capabilities of the FSTD should be indicated to meet the requirements of point ORA.FSTD.120, as amended by Regulation (EU) 2026/781.

Instructions on how to complete the ESL template are provided in AMC3 ORA.FSTD.120.

Application for FSTD qualification

AMC1 ORA.FSTD.200 establishes the template for the application for a newly qualified FSTD. The new AMC2 ORA.FSTD.200 clarifies the procedures to be followed in the application process and the timeline for submission of the documents specified in point ORA.FSTD.200, as amended by Regulation (EU) 2026/781.

2.3.2. AMC and GM to the Air OPS Regulation

AMC and GM to Part-ORO, Subpart FC

Regulation (EU) 2026/781 introduces the task-to-tool methodology and the FCS framework in operator recurrent training, where applicable. Amendments to AMC1 ORO.FC.145(d) introduce the acceptable means of compliance for an operator to determine the suitability of an FSTD with FCS or assigned FCS for training or checking. Separate arrangements have been developed for FSTDs for aeroplanes and for helicopters.

2.3.3. New CS-FSTD Issue 1

The new CS-FSTD Issue 1 prescribes standards for the initial qualification of all aeroplane and helicopter FSTDs based on the FCS framework and serves as the qualification basis for subsequent evaluations. It contains the description of FSTD features and fidelity levels (Subpart A), the general requirements for FSTDs with FCS (Subpart B), the necessary design data, validation data, validation data roadmap and associated documentation (Subpart C), the FSTD objective tests (Subpart D) and the FSTD functions and subjective tests (Subpart E).



CS-FSTD Issue 1 merges the specifications for the qualification of aeroplane and helicopter FSTDs into a single document. Apart from providing standards for qualification of each category of aircraft FSTDs, such merge is also beneficial for potential determination of specifications that would constitute special conditions for novel aircraft categories, such as electric vertical take-off and landing aircraft and tiltrotor aircraft, which may present characteristics of both aeroplanes and helicopters.

In order to qualify a training device, the technical standards of CS-FSTD Issue 1 should be met. In particular, CS-FSTD Issue 1 establishes the minimum FCS requirements for the qualification of an FSTD, with the intention of setting the boundary between devices which can be qualified as an FSTD and other training devices (OTDs) which do not need a qualification, but can be used for type rating training, where allowed.

Subpart B establishes, for each FSTD feature and fidelity level, the general requirements for the qualification of an FSTD. The associated GM illustrates or provides examples to support the understanding of the requirements for each FSTD feature and fidelity level.

Furthermore, CS-FSTD Issue 1 specifies that an FSTD with FCS should have statements of justification which explain and justify how the compliance of the FSTD with each general requirement was reached.

Subpart C establishes the types of data and associated documentation required to support the validation of the aircraft and cueing features during an initial evaluation.

Subpart D defines the tables of objective tests for aeroplane and rotorcraft FSTDs which should be used to determine the applicable tests to be included in the qualification test guide (QTG) and the tolerances and criteria applicable to each test.

Subpart E contains the tables of functions and subjective tests for aeroplane and helicopter FSTDs and defines the procedures to be used for determination of the applicable functions and subjective tests to an FSTD.

CS-FSTD Issue 1 implements a new flexible framework for the qualification of FSTDs with new technologies, allowing recognition of the FSTD real capabilities and sets up standards in a technologically agnostic manner. For example, the general requirements of CS-FSTD Issue 1 allow the qualification of training devices for fidelity level R with a full touchscreen representation of the aircraft flight deck layout and structure. Furthermore, CS-FSTD Issue 1 provides specifications for qualifying FSTDs using extended reality.

The structure of CS-FSTD Issue 1 follows a clearer and straightforward regulatory approach of specifying the specifications. These specifications are supported, where appropriate, by GM, to illustrate the meaning of a specific requirement. Contrary to the existing CS-FSTD, the new CS-FSTD Issue 1 does not include AMC. The rationale is that, by definition, certification specifications are technical standards which indicate the means to demonstrate compliance with the Basic Regulation and with the delegated and implementing acts adopted on the basis thereof. If CS-FSTD Issue 1 cannot serve as a qualification basis for an FSTD due to the novelty of such FSTD, point ORA.FSTD.210 of the Aircrew Regulation establishes the possibility to prescribe special conditions for the FSTD qualification basis.

After the applicability of the new CS-FSTD Issue 1, an FSTD will be initially qualified only with FCS.



2.4. Stakeholders' views

2.4.1. Overview of the comments on AMC and GM to the Aircrew and Air OPS Regulations

NPA 2024-101

In the context of the NPA 2024-101 focused consultation, EASA received 151 comments from the stakeholders. All comments have been reviewed and addressed. About 15 % of the comments on NPA 2024-101 were either accepted or partially accepted. About 75 % of the comments were not accepted. The rest of the comments were noted.

The EASA responses to the comments on NPA 2024-101 are provided in Appendix 1 to this Explanatory Note.

Out of the 151 comments received, 31 were related to the implementing rules, 10 of which were accepted. Such comments were considered in the preparation of Opinion No 01/2025, but are not presented in Appendix 1 as they are not related to the AMC and GM consulted.

61 comments were related to the fidelity levels in the training matrices. EASA conducted a thorough review of all the comments and considered them paying very close attention to both training and technical requirements for the qualification of FSTDs. In the vast majority of cases, such comments were not accepted as the proposed fidelity levels were either not acceptable in light of the technical requirements of CS-FSTD Issue 1, or they were not consistent with those of other similar training tasks, and the justification proposed was either not satisfactory or missing.

A number of comments proposed adding SATCE as an FSTD feature. At the moment, EASA does not consider it appropriate to include mandatory training requirements in Part-FCL for the use of SATCE for training, testing and checking. On a voluntary basis, FSTDs may include SATCE as an additional capability.

Some comments pointed out to some minor misalignments between NPA 2024-101 and the terminology used in CS-FSTD Issue 1. A review of the terminology used in NPA 2024-101 was carried out for the sake of consistent use of terminology.

Clarifications regarding the use of OTDs for training were accepted. Proposals for rewording of sentences for clarity were generally accepted.

NPA 2024-108

In the context of the NPA 2024-108 focused consultation, EASA received 125 comments from the stakeholders related to the amendments to AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart GEN and Subpart FSTD and AMC and GM to Part-ORA, Subpart FSTD.

About 62 % of the comments on NPA 2024-108 were either accepted or partially accepted. About 17 % of the comments were not accepted. The rest of the comments — around 22 % — were noted.

As a result of accepted and partially accepted comments, EASA initiated a complete revision of several AMC and GM (e.g. AMC2 ARA.GEN.200(a)(2), GM4 ARA.GEN.200(a)(2), AMC1 ORA.FSTD.100(d), GM1 ORA.FSTD.100 (d)). Among the major reasons for not accepting 21 comments are that:

- the proposals made by those comments were already covered in other places within AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD or Part-ORA, Subpart FSTD and hence are redundant; or
- such comments are addressed in the requirements adopted with Regulation (EU) 2026/781.



Comments that were noted are those of clarification nature or questions from the stakeholders. EASA takes note of a proposal for clarifying the competence and qualification of key personnel in an organisation operating the FSTD. The latter will be subject to discussion in the context of RMT.0196 Subtask 3.

The comments received on NPA 2024-108 and the EASA responses to them are provided in Appendix 3 to this Explanatory Note.

2.4.2. Overview of the comments on CS-FSTD Issue 1

In the context of the NPA 2024-102 focused consultation, EASA received 501 comments from the stakeholders. All of the comments have been reviewed and addressed. About 72 % of the comments were either accepted or partially accepted. About 20 % of the comments were not accepted. The rest of the comments were noted. Responses to all the comments are provided in Appendix 2 to this Explanatory Note.

Many comments pointed out minor editorial errors (e.g. typographical mistakes) in NPA 2024-102 which have been corrected. Several comments also identified sentences that could be restructured to improve clarity. These suggested changes were implemented where the comments were accepted. In addition, some comments proposed substantive changes. For those accepted, the revisions have been incorporated accordingly. Several comments requested to add more guidance on certain topics. A considerable amount of new guidance has been added to the final CS-FSTD Issue 1 in response to the stakeholders' comments and suggestions.

Partially accepted comments are those in which the underlying idea was accepted, but the suggested wording was adapted to maintain consistency within CS-FSTD Issue 1, or where the proposed change was only partially incorporated. Many comments in this category addressed terminology, while others also concerned substantive aspects.

Some comments were not accepted due to lack of alignment with the overall objectives and principles of the FCS framework or were deemed redundant, already addressed elsewhere. For instance, several comments suggested introducing detailed requirements for extended reality (XR) technologies. As these arrangements fall outside the scope of the current Subtask of RMT.0196, they will be considered at a later stage, and the related comments could not be accepted at this stage. Additionally, several comments proposed adding SATCE as an FSTD feature. As Part-FCL does not include mandatory training requirements for the use of SATCE, SATCE is not treated as an FSTD feature, but general requirements for SATCE are included in CS-FSTD Issue 1.

Some comments did not specify what should be changed or how the change should be implemented. These comments have been noted. Comments consisting solely of questions are also included in this category.



3. Expected benefits and drawbacks of the regulatory material

A detailed impact assessment was performed for the whole FCS concept and presented in Opinion No 01/2025. Please refer to Chapter 3 of said Opinion for information. No further or different assessment at the stage of issuance of these Decisions is considered necessary.



4. Monitoring and evaluation

The regulatory material issued with these Decisions is intended to support the implementation of Regulation (EU) 2026/781. EASA will monitor whether the objectives of the mentioned Regulation and the supporting AMC and GM will be achieved as part of the monitoring and evaluation actions described in Chapter 5 of Opinion No 01/2025.



5. Actions to support implementation

The regulatory material presented here will support the implementation of Regulation (EU) 2026/781. Furthermore, EASA will initiate IST.0007 ‘Support the implementation of the FSTD capability signature (FCS) framework’, which is defined in EPAS 2026 edition⁷. For more details, please refer to the description of the task in EPAS Volume II and to Chapter 6 of Opinion No 01/2025.

⁷ [European Plan for Aviation Safety \(EPAS\) 2026 - 15th edition | EASA](#)



6. References

Not applicable



7. Appendices

- Appendix 1 — Stakeholder comments on NPA 2024-101 and EASA responses to them
- Appendix 2 — Stakeholder comments on NPA 2024-102 and EASA responses to them
- Appendix 3 — Stakeholder comments on NPA 2024-108 and EASA responses to them
- Appendix 4 — Correlation table for AMC and GM to Part-ARA, Subpart FSTD
- Appendix 5 — Rationales behind the amended AMC and GM to the Aircrew Regulation and the Air OPS Regulation

